

Philosophical Foundations — Module 05: Action —

Study Questions

1. How does Peirce's account of inquiry parallel Active Inference? Map doubt → surprise, belief → posterior, inquiry → inference.
2. How does James's pragmatic theory of truth relate to model evidence?
3. How does Dewey's instrumentalism compare to Active Inference's treatment of generative models?
4. What is an affordance (Gibson)? How is it formalized in Active Inference terms?
5. How does EFE evaluation relate to affordance perception?
6. What does the "primacy of practice" mean philosophically? How does Active Inference support this claim?
7. How do epistemic actions demonstrate that cognition is action-dependent?
8. What are motor theories of perception? How do they support active inference?
9. How does Dewey's concept of habit map onto policy priors?
10. Compare Dreyfus's stages of expertise with generative model refinement.
11. What is skill acquisition in Active Inference terms?
12. How do shared generative models create shared affordances?
13. What are institutional affordances? Give three examples.
14. How does Active Inference account for normative affordances (what one "should" do)?
15. How does the pragmatist rejection of the spectator theory of knowledge parallel active inference?
16. Compare pragmatism's "truth as what works" with Bayesian model evidence. Are they the same thing?
17. How does Bruineberg & Rietveld's "optimal grip" relate to free energy minimization?
18. Can Active Inference accommodate the pragmatist idea of "warranted assertibility"?
19. How does the perception-action loop dissolve the traditional sensory-motor pipeline?
20. Critically evaluate: Is Active Inference genuinely pragmatist, or does its mathematical formalism reintroduce the spectator theory of knowledge?